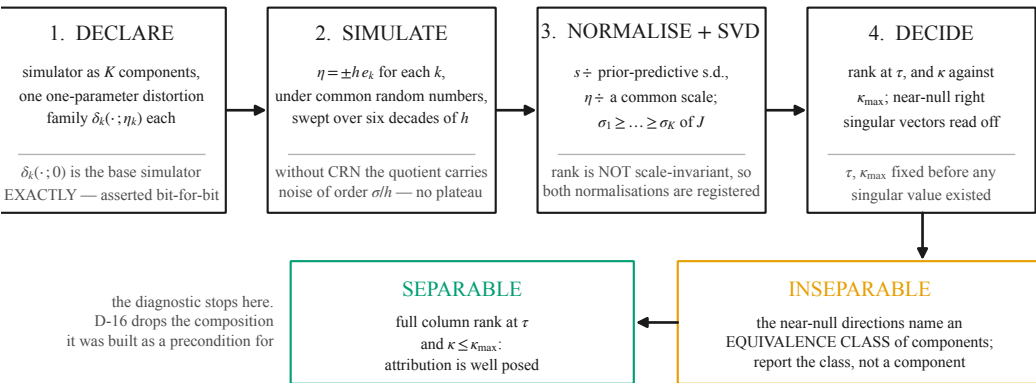


K components, one distortion family each: ■ η_1 transmission ■ η_2 progression ■ η_3 observation



a singular value moving by more than a factor of two across the h -plateau is counted toward the rank in NEITHER direction,
so the reported rank may be an interval rather than a number

the resolution test is a property of the ESTIMATOR and spectral density a property of the MATRIX: passing it does not answer
the objection that a gapless spectrum makes rank a threshold decision

the diagnostic never receives a component index or a ground-truth label: it computes a property of the map $s(\eta)$, so there is
no hidden truth available to leak into its answer